

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Senior Manager candidate with ~7 years across pension ALM, investment risk, and multi-asset portfolio analytics. Delivered ALM studies, LDI design, and asset allocation advice to Canadian and international pension plans at Ortec Finance – including investment manager due diligence and portfolio performance analysis; now holds delegated sign-off on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios at Moody's Analytics. Hands-on with VaR/CVaR portfolio optimization, risk decomposition and attribution, Python, and complex Excel. CFA charterholder, dual MSc.

CORE SKILLS

Pension ALM & LDI • Asset Allocation (SAA / TAA) • Portfolio Construction & Optimization (VaR / CVaR / Surplus) • Investment Risk Measurement (Duration / Stress / Scenario Analysis) • Liability Hedging & Derivative Overlays (Rates / FX / Inflation) • Risk Decomposition & Attribution • Python, SQL & Advanced Excel

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Portfolio Analytics & Investment Risk Oversight

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional pension and asset-manager clients ranging \$5-25bn per engagement; cumulatively cover ~\$50bn in institutional assets across the book of work.
- Review curve construction, spread calibration, cross-asset interactions, and aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics – prior to production release.
- Oversee duration and interest-rate risk measurement under parallel and non-parallel rate shocks, with outputs used to inform liability-aware positioning and funded-status sensitivity for pension mandates.
- Validate derivatives valuation outputs across rates, FX, and inflation; verify sensitivity consistency at portfolio-level ALM aggregates used in hedging and overlay decisions.

Cash-Flow Projection, Stress Testing & Reporting

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – providing forward-looking liquidity and funded-status visibility across ALM horizons.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed liquidity gap analytics (T+1 through multi-year), enabling funding optimization, refinancing risk assessment, and asset-allocation decisions.
- Prepared investment memos and analytical summaries for senior client stakeholders – including Heads of Risk and CIO-office contacts – covering interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities.

Tooling, Automation & Process Improvement

- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable, auditable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging and validation controls.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) for automated code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection – reducing analytical cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe analytics platform; advised on asset, liability, and ALM configurations and validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Acted as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, translating investment requirements into development requests; contributed to a successful Calypso-to-PFaroe migration across all assigned accounts.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - Financial Risk & IFRS Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning actuarial liability mechanics with investment-accounting and reporting frameworks.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and PM functions on milestone delivery, governance documentation, and regulatory-readiness materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

Pension ALM, LDI & Asset Allocation Advisory

- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors – analyzing funded ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet risk; prepared client-facing investment memos translating quantitative findings into actionable recommendations for investment committees.
- Advised plan sponsors on Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) and Tactical Asset Allocation (TAA) trade-offs via stress testing, sensitivity analysis, and stochastic scenario modelling, incorporating investment manager due diligence considerations on mandate sizing and structure.
- Conducted Liability-Driven Investment (LDI) analysis – evaluating trade-offs between return objectives, duration alignment, hedge-ratio choices, and liquidity considerations for pension-fund clients.
- Performed cash-flow, liquidity, and hedging analysis covering interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk, including derivative overlay strategies (leverage, FX hedging).
- Led onboarding and the ALM study for the University Pension Plan (UPP) merger – on a team of three, building and validating the model capturing Funding Policy dynamics, and studying duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.

Portfolio Construction, Risk & Performance Analytics

- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio construction and optimization based on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform; explored near-optimal portfolios around the efficient frontier to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Performed risk decomposition and risk attribution (contribution-to-risk, risk budgeting) across multi-asset portfolios, linking portfolio performance drivers to allocation and factor exposures.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators to assess investment performance, interest-rate risk, and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Presented findings at on-site client meetings and to pension-fund investment committees, translating quantitative outputs into actionable allocation and hedging recommendations.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016